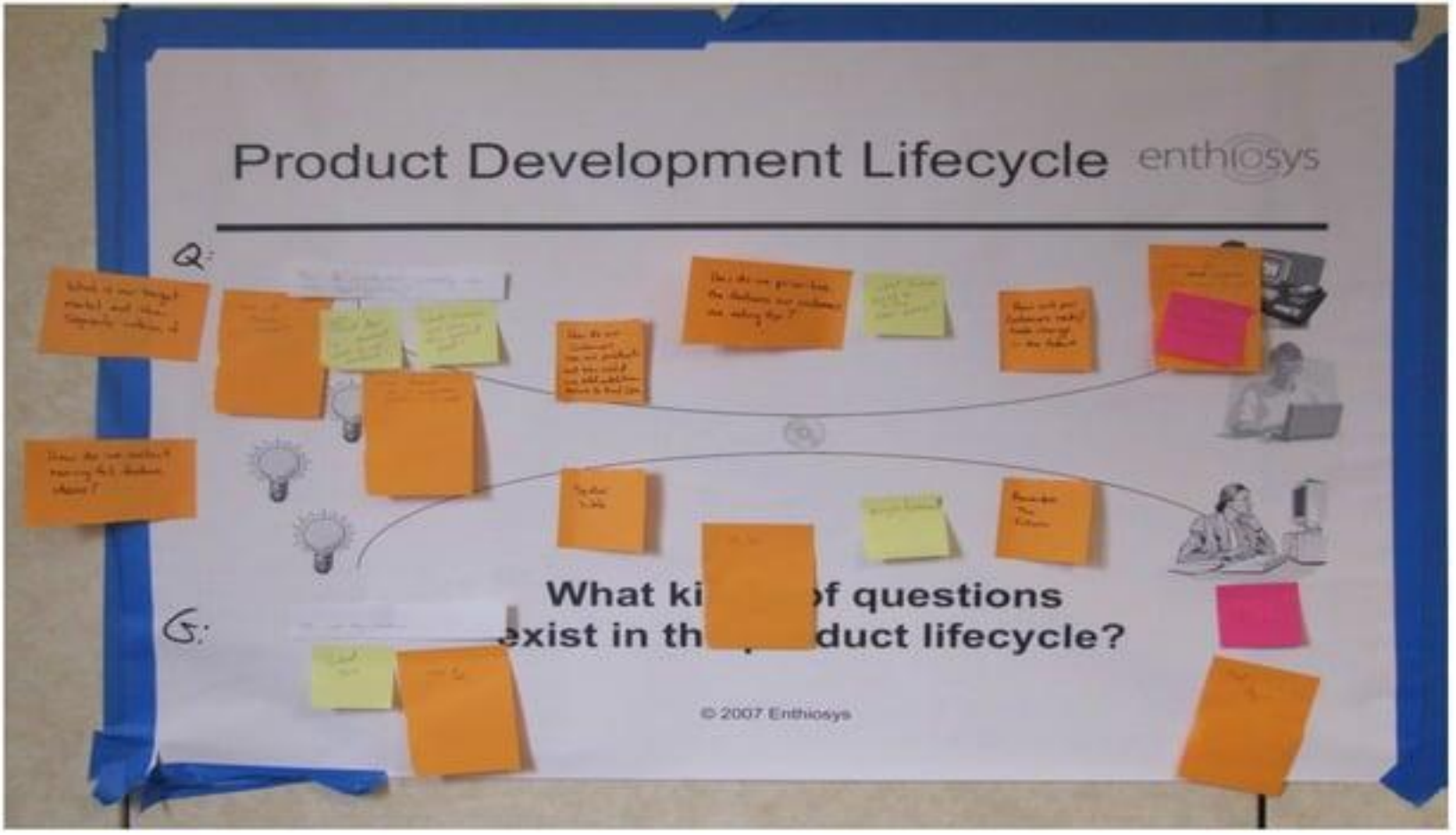
Agile/Lean Documentation

Agenda

- Critical points
- Why do people document?
- What is the relationship between documentation and project success?
- When does a model become permanent?
- Are agilists actually creating documentation and is
- **What are the issues associated with documentation?**
- **When should you create documentation?**
- **When should you update documentation?**
- **Best practices for increasing the agility of**

What & how to Doc?-Help Plz!



1. Critical Points

1. Fundamental issue → communication, not documentation.

2. Document stable → not speculative things.

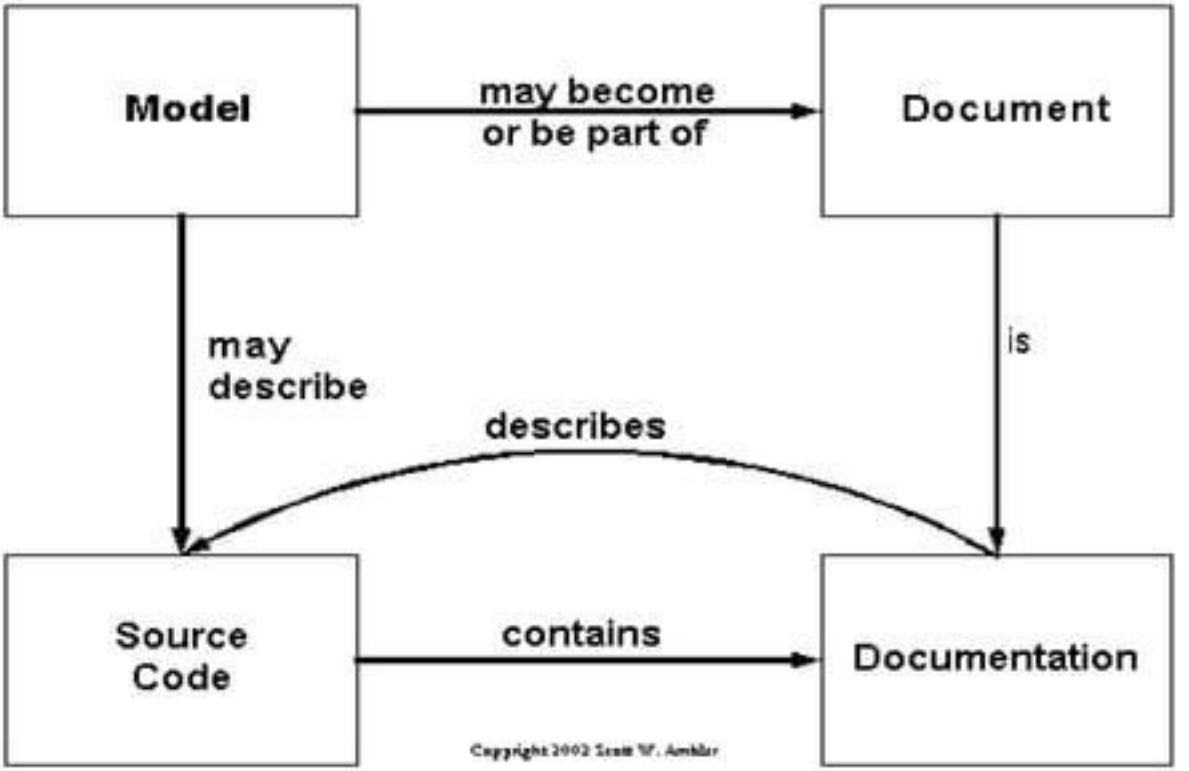
3. Evolutionary approach → seeking and then acting on feedback on a regular basis.

4. Well-written documentation supports organizational memory effectively, but is a poor way to communicate during a project.

5. Documentation should be concise: overviews/road maps are generally preferred over detailed documentation.

6. With high quality source code and a test suite to back it up we need a lot less system documentation.

Models, Documents, and Source Code

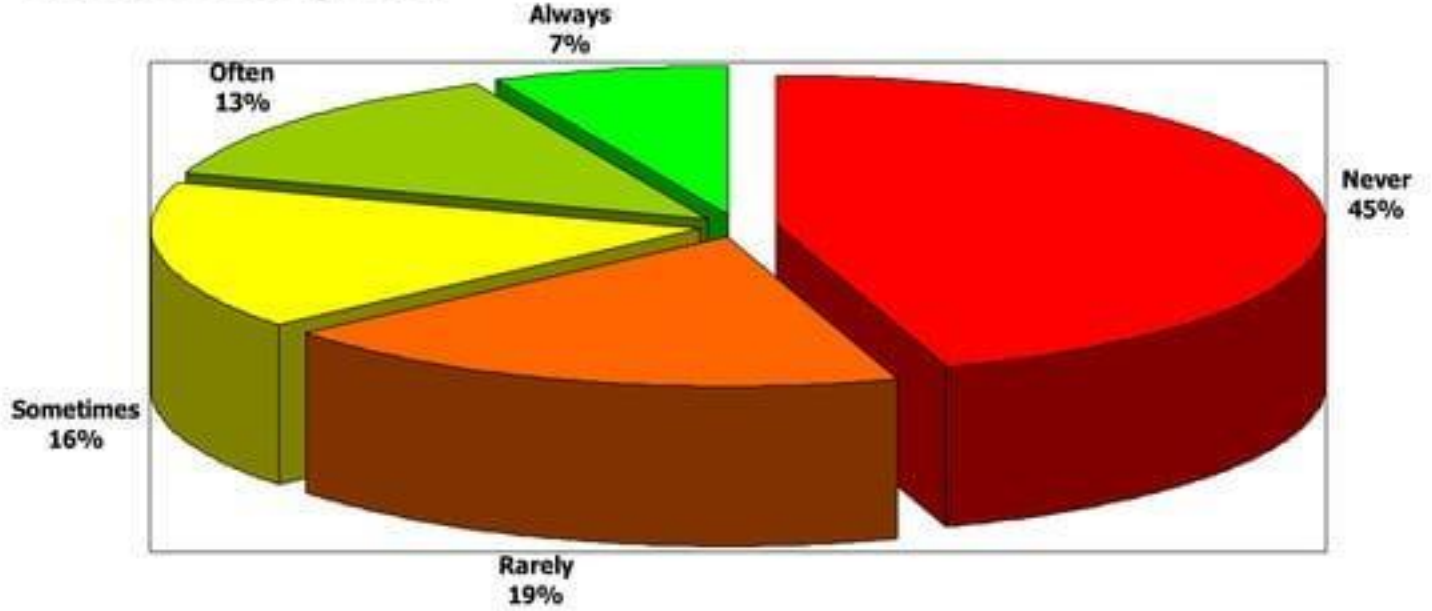


Why Do People Document?

- Your project stakeholders require it
- To support communication with an external group.
- To support organizational memory.
- For audit purposes.
- To think something through.

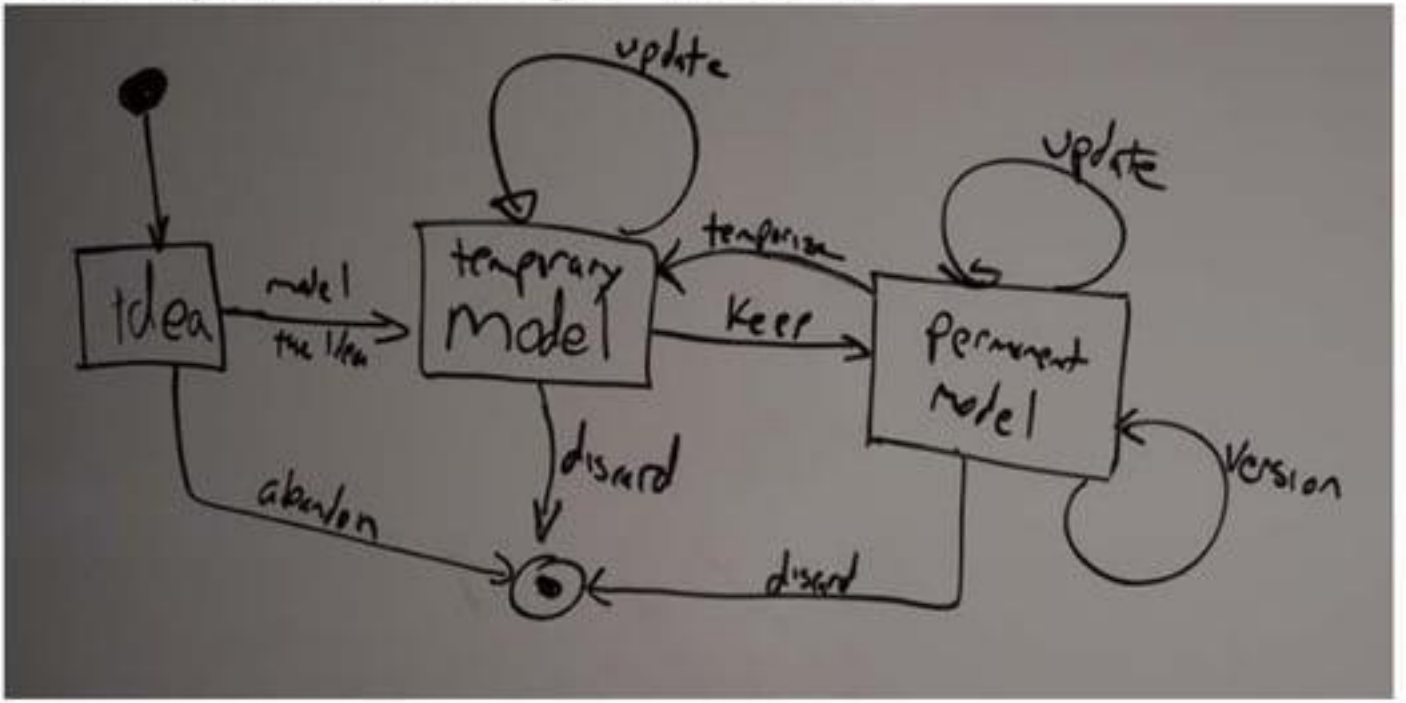
What is the Relationship Between Documentation and Project Success?

- Chaos Report →



5. When Does a Model Become Permanent?

- Life Cycle of an agile model.



What Are The Issues Associated With Documentation?

- Software development versus documentation development.
- Software developers have the knowledge, technical writers have the skill.
- What is required during development is often different than what is required after development.
- Do you document as you work or when you are finished?
- Quantity versus quality.

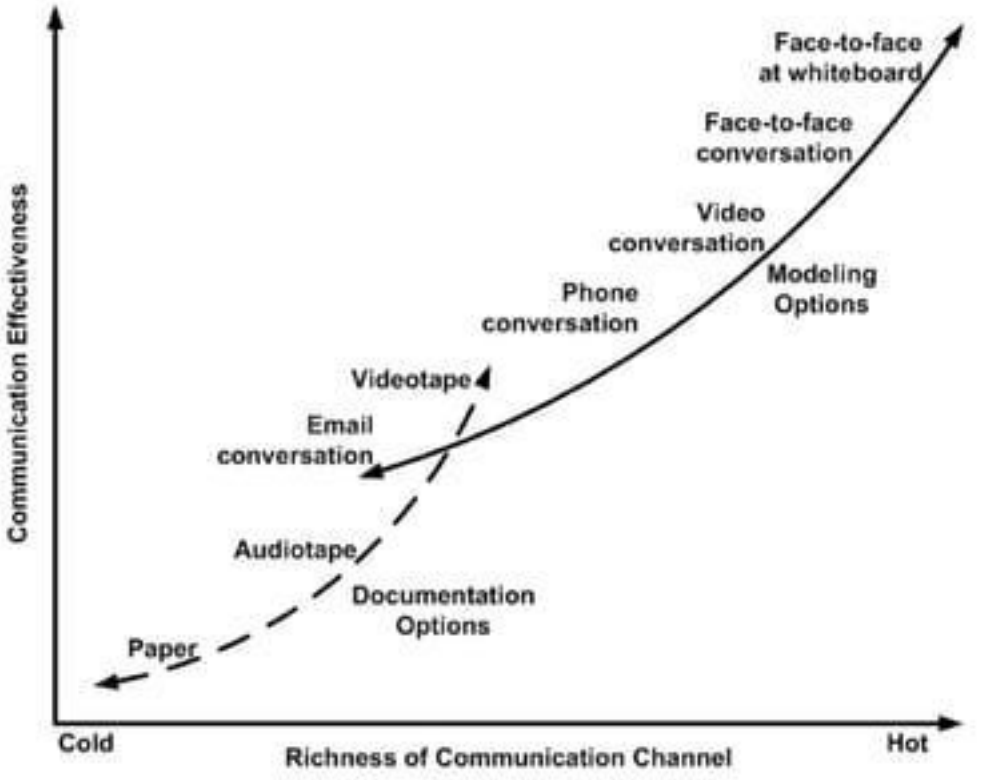
Can Templates Help?

- The template is time consuming and expensive to create
- People will actually fill them out
- Reviews take longer
- Total cost of ownership (TCO) increases.

How Can we Reduce Documentation

- C = The percentage of the document that is currently **"correct".**
- R = The chance that the document will be **read** by the intended audience.
- U = The percentage of the document that is actually **understood** by the intended audience.
- F = The chance that the material contained in document will be **followed.**
- T = The chance that the document will be **trusted**.

Comparing the effectiveness of various communication modes.



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Original Diagram Copyright 2002 Alistair Cockburn

Agile Documentation

1.Travel light – You need far less documentation than you think

2.Agile documents:

→ **Maximize stakeholder investment**

→ **Are concise**

→ **Fulfill a purpose**

→ **Describe information that is less likely to change**

→ **Describe "good things to know"**

→ **Have a specific customer and facilitate the work efforts of that customer**

→ **Are sufficiently accurate, consistent, and detailed**

→ **Are sufficiently indexed**

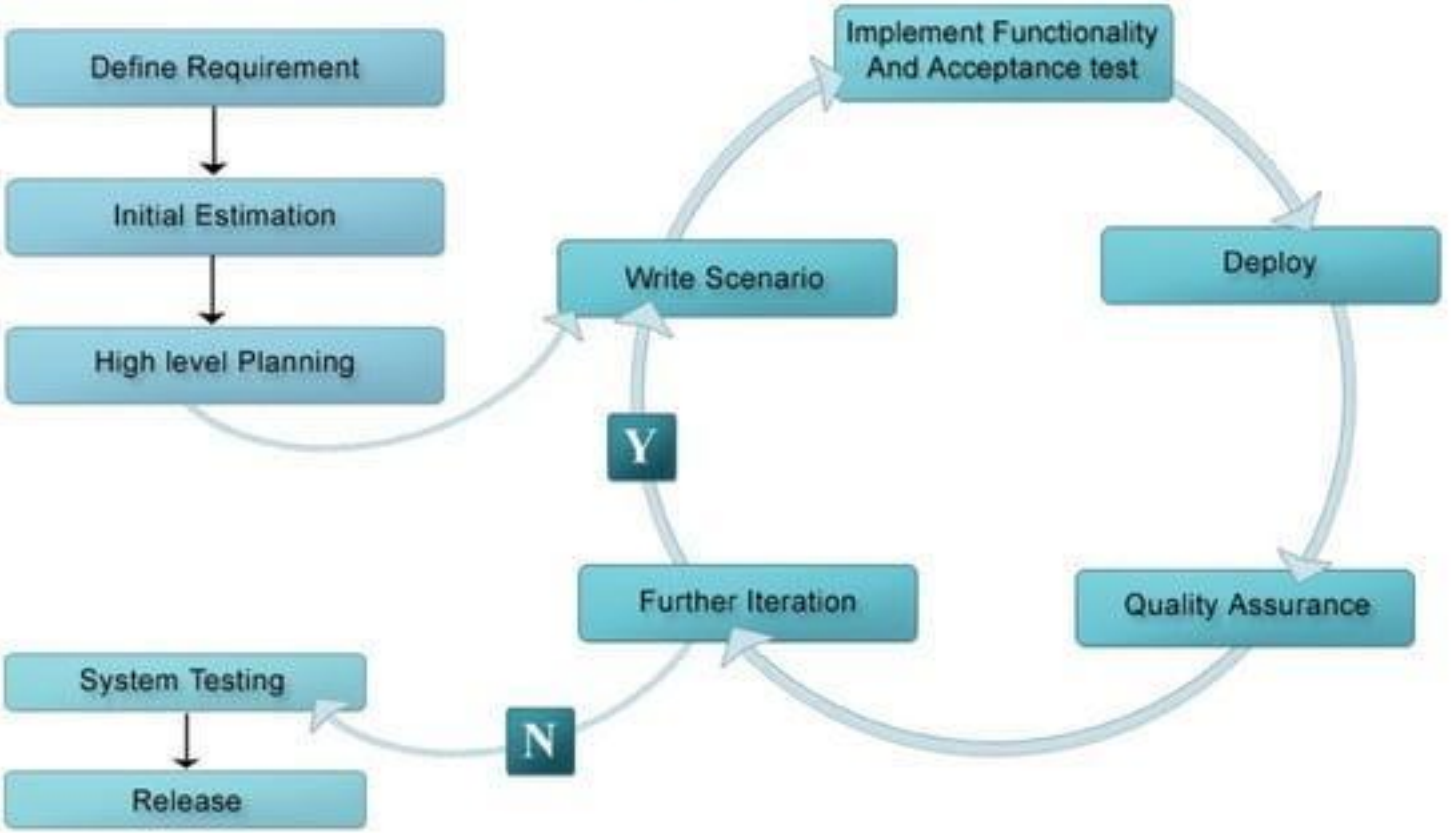
3. Valid reasons to document:

→ **Your project stakeholders require it**

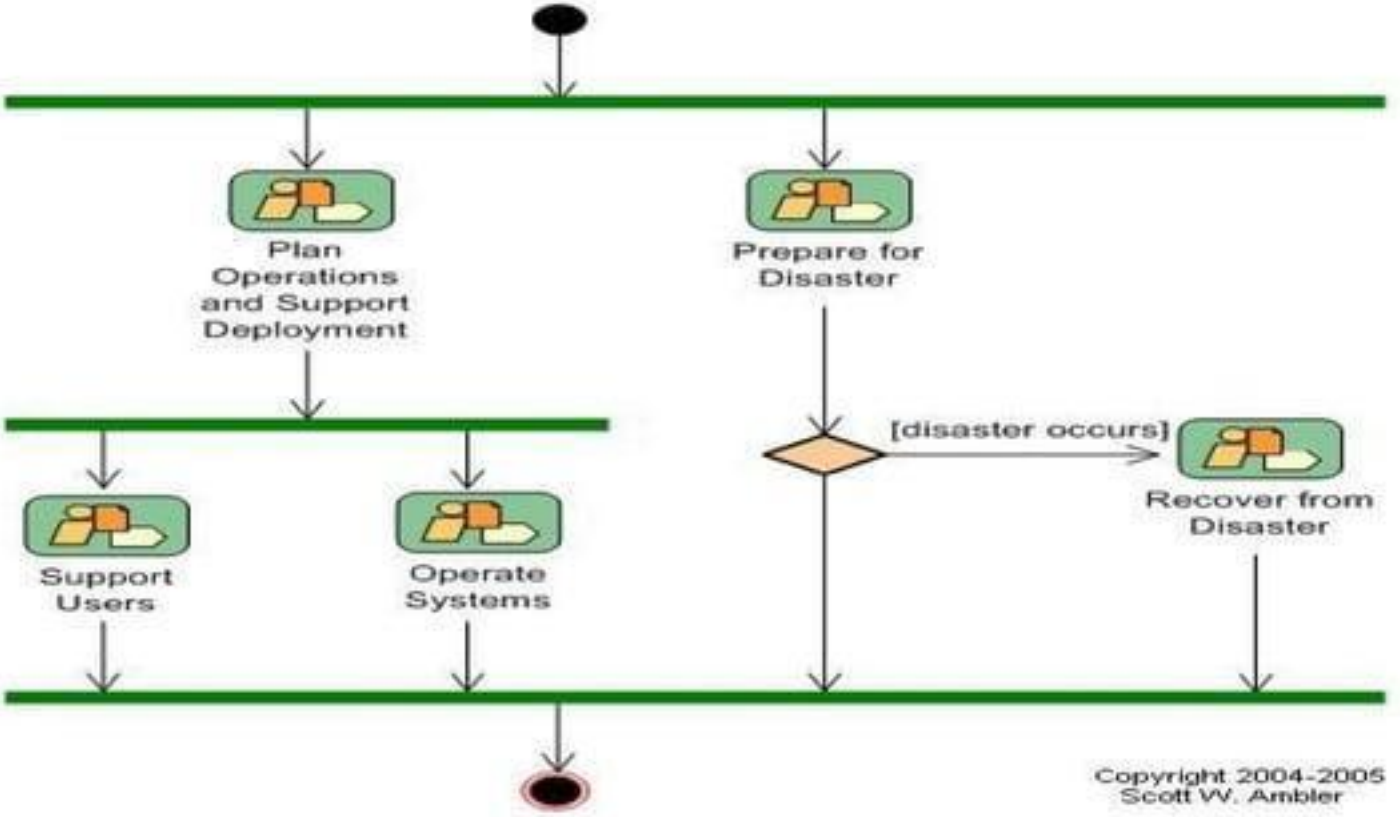
→ **To support communication with an external group**

→ **To think something through**

Agile software development life-cycle



The Operations and Support discipline work-flow



ADOPT...

- 'KISS' strategy .... agile revolves around it..

Questions?

•*I don't believe in **Santa Claus**, nor do I believe that programmers will keep external documentation up to date. Four decades of experience have shown that this particular dogma is **fantasy** at best.*

•*-Andreas Rueping.*

References :

Ambler, S.W. (2002). *Agile Modeling: Effective Practices for XP and the UP*. New York: John Wiley & Sons.

http://www.agilemodeling.com/essays/agileDocumentation.htm#StrategiesForAgileDocumentation